



Bhartiya Vidya Bhavan's
Sardar Patel Institute of Technology
(Autonomous Institute Affiliated to University of Mumbai)

CSE MCA Department

Name: Akanksha Hake
Sem: III AY: 2025-26

UCID: 2024510019
Course: EIPR

Class: SYMCA
Course Code: MC526

Case Study-1

Topic: Entrepreneurship and Business

Q1. Rohan, a 26-year-old engineer, has developed an **AI-powered app** that personalizes learning paths for students with different learning speeds. He wants to launch it in India, but the market already has players like BYJU's, Vedantu, and Unacademy. His challenge is limited funding, but he has strong technical expertise.

Questions for Students:

1. What type of entrepreneur is Rohan? Justify.
Rohan is an innovative entrepreneur. His AI-powered app has introduced a new process of personalized learning.
2. What type of business is this?
It is an Edtech Scalable startup.
3. Should he position his app as a niche product (for special learning needs like ADHD/slow learners) or compete directly with big players? Why?
Yes, he should position his app as a niche product since it is a gap in the current market and his product is focused on solving a problem rather than just building a product.
4. Suggest two revenue models he could adopt (subscription, freemium, institutional licensing, etc.) with reasoning.
Freemium - Offer a basic version of the app for free to attract a user base then advanced, AI-driven features such as in-depth analytics for parents or specialist - designed content could be locked in a paid subscription. This allows him to build a community and prove his app's value before asking all users to pay.
Institutional Licensing - Instead of marketing to individual parents and students, Rohan could license his app directly to schools, tutoring centres, and educational therapists who work with special needs children.



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Q2. Ananya, a doctor, notices that villagers in remote areas struggle to get access to medical care. She starts a **mobile health van service** equipped with telemedicine tools, connecting patients with city doctors via video calls. Her aim is not profit maximization but affordable healthcare access.

Questions for Students:

1. What type of entrepreneur is Ananya? Explain.
Ananya is a social entrepreneur since her primary goal is not profit maximization but to solve a critical social problem.
2. Is her business model profit-oriented, non-profit, or hybrid? Justify.
While her primary aim is social impact and not profit, a venture needs to be sustainable to have a long-term impact. A purely non-profit model would be entirely dependent on donations. However, a hybrid model allows her to pursue a social mission while generating some revenue to cover operational costs.
3. How can she sustain her venture in the long term (grants, CSR partnerships, government tie-ups, low-cost subscription from villagers)?
To ensure long-term sustainability, Ananya can explore multiple funding avenues:
Grants: Applying for grants from foundations and non-governmental organizations (NGOs) that focus on healthcare, technology for good, or rural development.
CSR Partnerships: She can partner with large corporations that have a corporate social responsibility (CSR) budget.
Government Tie-ups: Collaborating with government health missions or rural development programs can provide grants and operational support, integrating her service into the public healthcare infrastructure.
Low-Cost Subscriptions: Introducing a nominal subscription fee for villagers could create a predictable revenue stream and a sense of ownership among the community, ensuring the venture remains "customer-focused".
4. Suggest ways to scale her impact without losing the social mission.

Ananya can scale her impact by focusing on empowerment and technology. She could train local community health workers to operate the telemedicine equipment, conduct basic health check-ups, and manage the mobile vans and can use technology to create a central platform that connects a larger pool of city doctors with multiple remote locations.



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Q3. Amit and Priya have created a **peer-to-peer fashion rental platform** (like Airbnb for clothes), targeting urban millennials who prefer renting outfits for events. Investors are interested, but scaling requires logistics, partnerships, and branding.

Questions for Students:

1. What type of entrepreneur(s) are Amit and Priya? Why?
Amit and Priya are best described as scalable startup entrepreneurs because their business, a peer-to-peer online platform, is inherently designed for rapid growth.
2. What type of business model are they pursuing (service, online platform, retail hybrid)?
They are pursuing an online platform model. Their business creates value by connecting two distinct groups of users like suppliers and customers.
3. What are the risks in scaling such a business (supply-demand mismatch, quality control, delivery costs)?
They might have risks like too many renters are looking for specific types of dresses (eg. for a festival) but not enough owners supplying them, or vice-versa. Also, as more suppliers join, ensuring that all listed clothes are in good condition, clean, and accurately described becomes difficult. A few bad experiences can damage the platform's reputation. Managing the delivery, return, and professional cleaning of garments across a city or country is complex and expensive. The platform must handle potential issues like damage to clothes, late returns, or disputes between renters and owners, which can be a significant operational burden.
4. Suggest strategies to attract and retain both **suppliers** (clothes owners) and **customers** (renters).
To attract suppliers, they can clearly communicate the earning potential of their underused wardrobe and also offer an insurance against damage or theft to reduce their risk and build trust in the platform. To retain them, they can make the process of listing clothes, managing bookings, and receiving payments as simple as possible and can create a community for top suppliers with special perks, insights, and support. Whereas for customers, marketing the service as a smart, affordable, and sustainable way to access a "revolving closet" for special events, directly addressing the pain point of buying expensive, single-use outfits while offering first-time rental discounts or referral bonuses to encourage trial, this can attract the users. To retain them, they can ensure a high-quality, curated selection of clothes, reliable delivery, and excellent customer support to address a potential gap in the market while also using an algorithm or AI to provide personalized style recommendations based on past rentals and preferences, making the platform more valuable with each use.



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Q4. Suresh owns a **family-run sweet shop** in a small town. He has loyal local customers but faces competition from new branded chains like Haldiram's. He is unsure whether to expand online (via Zomato/Swiggy) or just maintain his local store.

Questions for Students:

1. Identify the type of entrepreneur Suresh is. Why?
Suresh is a small business entrepreneur since his business is a family-run, local sweet shop that serves a neighbourhood community.
2. What type of business is this?
This is a small business. It's a traditional, brick-and-mortar retail operation focused on a specific local market.
3. Should he go online (delivery apps) or remain traditional? Justify based on costs, risks, and customer base.
Suresh should adopt a hybrid approach, i.e maintaining his local store while carefully expanding online since adjusting to the changing market conditions is crucial for long-term success. He should start small, then scale by listing a limited menu of his best-selling items on Zomato/Swiggy to test the demand and understand the operational costs and logistics before committing fully. Going online allows him to reach a new segment of customers who prefer the convenience of delivery apps, without abandoning the loyal, local customers who are the foundation of his business. Remaining purely traditional may protect his current base but leaves him vulnerable to losing younger, tech-savvy customers to competitors over time.
4. Suggest at least two strategies for competing with bigger chains while keeping his small business identity.

Suresh can compete effectively by leveraging his unique identity.

- Suresh cannot compete with large chains on price, but he can win on authenticity. He should focus on what makes his shop unique like decades-old family recipes, high-quality local ingredients, and the personal relationships he has with his customers.
- Suresh can use creative techniques to innovate to create fusion sweets that combine traditional recipes with modern flavours (e.g., a coffee-flavored rasgulla or a dark chocolate barfi). He could also offer healthier versions of traditional sweets using jaggery or sugar-free alternatives to cater to a new, health-conscious customer segment.



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Q5. A large company (let's say **Tata Motors**) wants to develop **electric two-wheelers** to compete with Ola and Ather. The company is resource-rich but slow in innovation.

Questions for Students:

1. What type of entrepreneur does this represent?
It represents a large company entrepreneur.
2. What type of business is this (manufacturing/service/hybrid)?
This business would be a hybrid of manufacturing and service.
3. How can a corporate giant compete with startups that are faster and more agile?
A corporate giant can compete with faster and more agile startups by leveraging its core strengths and adopting startup strategies. The key is to overcome its slowness in innovation. A large company entrepreneur achieves this by forming beneficial partnerships with other businesses and identifying smaller companies for acquisition. By either buying or partnering with an agile tech company, the corporate giant can instantly acquire the speed and innovation it lacks.
4. Suggest two strategies (R&D investment, partnerships, acquisitions, customer incentives).
 - The most direct way to compete is to acquire a smaller, innovative company in the EV space. This allows the corporate giant to instantly integrate cutting-edge technology, a fast-moving culture, and proven talent.
 - The company can create an independent internal division dedicated to the new EV. By giving this team significant resources and autonomy, it empowers intrapreneurs to innovate rapidly.

Q6. What are different Components of a Business ?

The key functions that make up a business venture can be categorized into four main components: management, operations, finance, and marketing.

1. Management

It is the responsible for setting the company's direction and overseeing all its functions to ensure goals are met. It involves planning, organizing, and leading the team.

2. Operations

Operations refers to the process of creating and delivering a company's product or service. This is the core function that generates value for customers.

3. Finance

Finance is the component that manages the monetary resources of the business. Its role is to ensure the company has the money it needs to operate and grow.

4. Marketing & Sales

It is the bridge between a company's product and its customers. This component is responsible for understanding the market, finding potential buyers, and generating revenue.



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Q7. What are different types of Business?

Businesses can be classified by the nature of their goals and the type of entrepreneur running them into the following types:

1. Small Business:

A small business is a venture that typically serves a local community and is not intended for massive, rapid growth. These are run by small business entrepreneurs.

2. Scalable Startup:

A scalable startup is a company created to grow very quickly. These ventures, run by scalable startup entrepreneurs, often have an innovative product or business model and seek outside investment to expand.

3. Social Venture:

A social venture is a business where the primary goal is to solve a social problem and create a positive impact, rather than to maximize profit. These are led by social entrepreneurs.

4. Large Company / Corporation:

This refers to an established, large-scale corporation. While not a startup, entrepreneurship can still occur within these businesses through large company entrepreneurs or intrapreneurs. These are individuals who innovate and develop new products or find growth opportunities from within the larger company structure.

Q8. What are the Functions within a Business ?

The primary functions within a business are management, operations, finance, and marketing.

1. Management

It is the responsible for setting the company's direction and overseeing all its functions to ensure goals are met. It involves planning, organizing, and leading the team.

2. Operations

Operations refers to the process of creating and delivering a company's product or service. This is the core function that generates value for customers.

3. Finance

Finance is the component that manages the monetary resources of the business. Its role is to ensure the company has the money it needs to operate and grow.

4. Marketing

It is the bridge between a company's product and its customers. This component is responsible for understanding the market, finding potential buyers, and generating revenue.

Q9. What is the Metrics of Successful Business ?

The metrics of a successful business can be understood through its financial performance, its value to customers, and its broader impact on the economy.

1. Financial Profitability - A primary and fundamental metric of success for an entrepreneur is to make a profit. For high-growth startups, success can also be measured by a significant financial exit, such as an acquisition.

2. Customer Value and Problem-Solving - Beyond profit, a key goal and measure of success for entrepreneurship is to create value and solve problems for customers. A business is successful when it effectively addresses a pain point or an unmet need in the market.

3. Economic and Social Impact - On a broader scale, a successful business contributes positively to the economy and society. Entrepreneurs are described as "essential drivers of economic progress". Their success can be measured by their ability to generate employment, raise living standards, and invigorate local and global economies.



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Q10. What makes an Entrepreneur ?

An entrepreneur is defined by a combination of ten key personal and professional characteristics.

Motivation: The inner drive to achieve goals and pursue a vision.

Passion: A deep and genuine enthusiasm for their work and ideas.

Vision: The ability to see a clear picture of the future and what they want to create.

Confidence: A strong belief in their own abilities and the viability of their venture.

Decision-making: The skill to make timely and effective choices, often with incomplete information.

Innovation: The capacity to introduce new ideas, products, or methods.

Risk-taking: The willingness to commit resources to ventures with uncertain outcomes.

Curiosity: A desire to learn, explore new possibilities, and question the status quo.

Persistence: The determination to continue moving forward despite setbacks and challenges.

Leadership: The ability to inspire, guide, and motivate a team toward a common goal.